PORTFOLIO BUILDING B25CS0311

Activity 13: Global Tech Ambassador & Open-Source Pathway Selection

Student: Vighnesh P Kanhirakandi Semester: 3rd Semester B.Tech CSIT Expected Graduation: 2029

1. Selected Programs

The two selected pathways are HackerRank Campus Crew and GitHub Campus Experts. They align with my current interests in coding, GitHub, technical presentations, leadership, open-source learning and technical-community development.

Criteria	HackerRank Campus Crew	GitHub Campus Experts
Purpose	Student ambassador program focused on coding, campus events, peer mentoring and developer-community building.	Student leadership program focused on building and growing a college technical community.
Eligibility	Currently enrolled college/university student interested in coding and community.	GitHub user for at least 6 months; 18+; enrolled in formal higher education; more than one year left before graduation; student status validated through the GitHub Student Developer Pack.
Application cycle	The current official page shows an application route and does not state a closing date.	Applications open every July for one month. The July 2026 cycle has passed; the next regular cycle is expected in July 2027 unless GitHub announces otherwise.
Process	Apply, complete a short coding challenge, attend an interview, then selection as a campus ambassador.	Submit an application form, then a video resume if invited to the next stage; selected students begin training/onboarding.
Benefits	Industry mentorship, certificate of experience, early feature access, HackerRank Plus, community access, welcome kit/milestone rewards and career opportunities.	Six-week training, mentorship and support, with development of leadership, public speaking, technical writing and software-development skills, followed by a community impact proposal.
Personal fit	Matches my coding/DSA practice, programming interests, presentation experience and interest in developing leadership skills.	Matches my GitHub project work, presentation experience, technical interests and goal of developing community-building skills.

2. Current Portfolio & Gap Analysis

Area	Current evidence	Gap / action needed
Coding	C/C++, DSA and problem-solving practice through coding exercises and academic projects.	Increase consistent problem-solving practice and build stronger public evidence of coding ability.
GitHub / projects	GitHub repositories including Decodes Lab, LeetCode solutions, Hello World C, Mini Project and the Innovation Procurement Bridge contribution.	Improve documentation, README quality and contribution history.
Open source	Contribution to the Innovation Procurement Bridge/SIH-related team project repository.	Build independent contributions to public open-source repositories and document them clearly.
Technical writing	Portfolio and project documentation experience through academic activities and README/report preparation.	Create two beginner-friendly technical write-ups.
Community involvement	Interest in technology outreach and becoming a Technology Ambassador; currently building experience.	Participate in or assist with a small coding/community activity.
Leadership	Team participation in hackathon/SIH work and experience working collaboratively on technical tasks.	Extend leadership from project/team settings into technical community activities.
Public speaking	Experience preparing and giving academic/technical presentations.	Use this strength in workshops, peer-learning sessions and community activities.
GitHub Education	GitHub Student Developer Pack status should be verified before a future Campus Expert application.	Apply for GitHub Education and complete student verification if not already completed.

3. Four-Week Preparation Roadmap

Week	Actions	Expected output
Week 1 – Foundation	Increase HackerRank practice. Improve GitHub profile and README files. Apply for GitHub Education/Student Developer Pack.	More coding activity, improved GitHub profile and Education application submitted.
Week 2 – Technical writing	Write two short beginner-friendly technical articles: one about Git/GitHub and one about starting coding/problem solving in C/C++.	Two technical write-ups demonstrating clear technical communication.
Week 3 – Community	Conduct or assist with a small beginner coding/practice session for peers. Share simple coding resources or problems and collect feedback.	Evidence of peer-learning/community participation.
Week 4 – Application portfolio	Organize GitHub projects and contribution evidence. Update resume/profile. Prepare HackerRank Campus Crew motivation and GitHub Campus Experts motivation/community-impact responses.	Clean, application-ready portfolio and draft responses.

4. Drafted Application Material — Technical Community Motivation

I want to become more actively involved in building a technical community at my college while continuing to improve my own technical skills. As a Computer Science and Information Technology student, I have been developing my foundation through C/C++, DSA, Python, AI/ML learning, GitHub projects, a contribution to my SIH-related team project, and technical presentations. These experiences have helped me understand the importance of communication, teamwork and completing technical work together.

At this stage, I want to move beyond learning technology individually and start sharing what I learn with other students. I believe many students are interested in coding and technology but may not know where to begin or may hesitate to participate. I would like to help create an approachable environment where students can practice coding, learn Git and GitHub, participate in hackathons and discover opportunities in the developer community.

I also see this as an opportunity to improve myself. I am still early in my technical journey, so I do not want to present myself as an expert. Instead, I want to learn continuously, contribute consistently and grow together with the students around me. Through a student technology community program, I hope to develop stronger leadership, public speaking, technical writing and community-building skills while creating useful opportunities for my peers.

5. Personal Action Targets

1. Reach at least 15–20 total HackerRank problems and maintain consistent practice.

2. Complete GitHub Education/Student Developer Pack verification.

3. Publish two beginner-friendly technical write-ups.

4. Build evidence of at least one peer-learning or technical community activity.

5. Continue contributing to public/open-source projects independently where appropriate.

6. Keep GitHub repositories documented and application-ready.

6. References

Official course activity document: Portfolio Building B25CS0311, Activity 13 — Global Tech Ambassador & Open-Source Pathway Selection.

HackerRank official: Campus Crew Program — program description, eligibility, activities, application process and benefits.

GitHub official documentation: Applying to be a GitHub Campus Expert; About GitHub Campus Experts — eligibility, training and community-development information.